

Nicholas Dunagan

Curriculum Vitae

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Fields

Industrial Organization, Game Theory, Innovation, Intellectual Property & Technology, Trade

Education

Ph.D. in Economics Aug. 2022 to Present

Clemson University

Clemson, SC

Committee: Charles Thomas, F. Andrew Hanssen, Scott L. Baier, Matthew S. Lewis

B.B.A. in Economics Aug. 2018 to December 2021

Texas State University

San Marcos, TX

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record Fall 2024 to Present

Clemson University

Clemson, SC

- International Economy (7 Sections)

Teaching Assistant Fall 2022 to Summer 2024

Clemson University

Clemson, SC

- Principles of Microeconomics (3 Sections)

- Principles of Macroeconomics (3 Sections)

- International Economy (1 Section)

Current Research

Job Market Paper

Strategic Search in Patenting

Dunagan, N.

I develop a three-player game-theoretic model of patenting. An *applicant* chooses how extensively to search for prior art, determining the information brought into the patenting process and the claimed patent breadth. An *examiner* conducts additional search and might narrow the claimed breadth. A *challenger* conducts additional search and might challenge the patent. The public record from earlier search affects the likelihood of challenge by affecting the informativeness of later search. My equilibrium characterization yields comparative statics for how search and breadth respond to challenger filing costs, procedural standards, and examiner capacity. These results generate testable implications for patent breadth, grant outcomes, and post-grant challenge behavior.

Working Papers

Strategic Search in Patenting: An Empirical Investigation

Dunagan, N.

I examine how the threat of post-grant patent review affects applicant and examiner behavior during patent prosecution. Using a newly constructed dataset linking U.S. patent applications and grants through 2020 and an exposure-based difference-in-differences design, I find that greater exposure to post-grant review leads to narrower patent claims. A one-standard-deviation increase in historical litigation exposure is associated with approximately 2.25 additional words in minimum independent claim length at publication.

The Effects of Focused Deterrence on Crime and Community Outcomes in Philadelphia

Eaton, M., Dunagan, N., & Stalvey, B.

We examine the effects of Philadelphia's 2013 Focused Deterrence program on crime and neighborhood outcomes. Using a difference-in-differences design, we find that shooting victims declined by 41.3 percent and gun crime incidents by 24.2 percent. These reductions in crime were accompanied by increases in rental prices and housing values, suggesting that improved neighborhood safety was capitalized into local housing markets.

Works in Progress

Judicial Bias in Capital Sentencing in Early 20th Century South Carolina

Eaton, M. & Dunagan, N.

Trade Shocks, Migration, and House Prices: The Role of Housing-Supply Elasticity

Baier, S., Dunagan, N., & Reesman, W.

Radical Innovation and Innovation Strategy

Dunagan, N.

Research Presentations

Southern Economic Association 96th Annual Meeting, Houston, TX	Fall 2026
Clemson Industrial Organization Economics Workshop, Clemson, SC	Spring 2026
Southern Economic Association 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL	Fall 2025
Clemson Industrial Organization Economics Workshop, Clemson, SC	Fall 2025
Clemson Industrial Organization Economics Workshop, Clemson, SC	Spring 2025
Clemson Industrial Organization Economics Workshop, Clemson, SC	2024

Awards & Honors

Dr. Myles Wallace Annual Fellowship in Economics

2026 to Present

Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics

Dr. Michael T. Maloney Annual Fellowship in Economics

2025 - 2026

Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics

Graduate Assistant Excellence Award in Teaching <i>Clemson University - Powers College of Business</i>	2025
Economics Department Travel Grant <i>Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics</i>	2025
Clemson University Graduate Student Government Travel Grant <i>Clemson University - Graduate Student Government</i>	2024 - 2026
Clemson University Department of Economics Graduate Assistantship <i>Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics</i>	2022 to Present
Texas State University Outstanding Undergraduate Student in Economics <i>Texas State University - McCoy College of Business</i>	2022
Larry and Robin Kapavik Scholarship <i>Texas State University</i>	2020-2021
Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society <i>Texas State University</i>	Fall 2020
Beta Gamma Sigma Honor Society <i>Texas State University</i>	Fall 2019

Specialized Skills

Programming: Python, Stata, R, C++

Libraries & Data Tools: pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, pyarrow, BeautifulSoup

Research & Document Tools: L^AT_EX, Quarto, Bloomberg Terminal, Microsoft Office Suite

Version Control & AI Tools: Git, GitHub, ChatGPT, Claude

References

Charles Thomas
Clinical Professor of Economics
Clemson University
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